

Problem #3: The Matses Hunter Boy

Solution:

Assignment 1: Write down the number (1 to 6) of the Matses sentence next to the scenarios (A to F) that it corresponds to. .			
Scenario	Matses sentence #	Scenario	Matses sentence #
A	6	D	1
B	4	E	3
C	5	F	2
Assignment 2: Write down the Matses translations.			
a) They passed by. <i>kuen-nëdak-onda-şh</i>			
b) Non-Matses Indians built a hut. <i>matses-utsi bëste-wa-nëdak-o-şh</i>			
c) Matses Indians built a hut. <i>matses bëste-wa-ak-o-şh</i>			

Explanation:

Assignment 3:

Translation: *Abhishek built a hut.*

The actual translation is : “I (the speaker) **found out long ago** that Abhishek built a hut a **long time before that.**”

Any scenario that meets the following two criteria will work :

1. The speaker found out that Abhishek built the hut a long time after Abhishek built it.
2. The moment of discovery (when the speaker found out about Abhishek building the hut) happened a long time before the present moment.

E.g. The speaker can utter this sentence in 2020 if Abhishek had built the hut in 2000 and the speaker found out about it in 2010.

Assignment 4:

4a. Tense and evidentiality:

	Recent past	Distant past
When did the event occur? (with reference to my discovery of the event) Tense marker	ak	nědak
When did I “discover” or gain knowledge about the event? (with reference to current time, i.e. time of speech) Evidentiality marker	o	onda

4b. Distinguishing between recent past and distant past

Based on the data of the problem, recent past includes everything from the immediate past to a few days ago. The distant past includes everything before a few days ago.

4c. Morphology, Syntax, Vocabulary:

- SOV : Subject_Object_Verb
- subject*_object_verb_tense marker_evidentiality marker_person marker/ʃh
 - subject is optional (null subject) if the subject is
 - 3rd person pronoun i.e. he/she/it/they
 - *There isn't enough data to tell whether the last morpheme is merely 'ʃh' or a specific grammatical person marker.*
- -utsi is used as a negation marker. (matses-utsi = non-Matses Indian)

4d.

běste = hut; wa = to build; kuen = to pass by; chotac = foreigner; matses = Matses Indian